

SENATE RESOLUTION 56

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Patricia Pryor Degrafinreid on the celebration of her seventieth birthday.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pay tribute to those citizens who are celebrating special occasions in their estimable lives; and

WHEREAS, Patricia Pryor Degrafinreid will celebrate her seventieth birthday on April 2, 2025, a milestone commemorated as yet another precious souvenir of life's rich pageant; and

WHEREAS, born on April 2, 1955, in Drummonds, Mrs. Degrafinreid is one of Sampson and Josephine Pryor's twelve children and was the first woman in her family to attend college, graduating from Tennessee State University in August 1978 and ultimately earning her master's degree from Trevecca Nazarene University in 1992; and

WHEREAS, Pat Degrafinreid's foray into her education career was at Brighton Elementary School, teaching math to at-risk students; in 1981, she moved to Memphis, where she taught at various schools throughout the city school system; and

WHEREAS, wholly devoted to her family, she enjoyed the love and companionship of her husband, Alfred Degrafinreid, Sr., until his passing in 1998, and has been blessed with three children, Patrick Wakefield, Althea Degrafinreid, and Alfred Degrafinreid II, and several grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, she is a devoted member of Rock of Ages C.M.E. Church in Memphis, where she has served as a Sunday School teacher and Usher Board president; and

WHEREAS, as Pat Degrafinreid gracefully enters her seventieth year, she remains a positive force for good, admired for her wisdom, spirit of generosity, integrity, and enthusiasm for life; and

WHEREAS, we wish to grasp this golden opportunity to specially recognize one of Tennessee's most outstanding citizens on this very special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we hereby honor and congratulate Patricia Pryor Degrafinreid on the celebration of her seventieth birthday and extend to her our best wishes for many happy returns of the day.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.